Somdeepa Das

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Economics of Higher Education

Education

Purdue University Daniels School of Business, West Lafayette, IN
PhD in Economics Expected August 2027
Dissertation Committee: Jillian Carr (Chair), Tim Bond, Kevin Mumford, and Tim Moore
Dissertation: "Essays on the Economic Consequences of Policy and Institutional Change"
Master of Science in Economics 2024

Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India
MA in Economics 2019

Jadavpur University, Kolkata, India
BA in Economics 2017

Research

Job Market Paper

What Do Unions Do for Professionals? Evidence from Faculty Unionization in U.S. Higher Education [Paper]
with Jay Tan
Combines the staggered timing of faculty unionization at U.S. colleges and universities from 1993 to 2023 with institution-level IPEDS data and restricted-use Survey of Doctorate Recipients microdata to study effects on salaries, employment, and faculty careers. Unionization does not raise average tenure-line salaries, but unionizing institutions employ fewer assistant professors and faculty who remain experience faster salary growth, especially outside the tenure track.

Working Papers

Does Easier Alcohol Access Affect Road Safety? Insights from Texas Municipal Elections [Paper] [Cato Research Brief, 2026]
with Tong Li
Uses close local option elections in Texas to study how expanded alcohol access affects traffic safety. Legalization increases liquor licenses, driven almost entirely by off-premise retailers, and shifts sales toward retail outlets without increasing total crashes, DUI crashes, or fatal crashes.

Works in Progress

Legalized Sports Betting and College Performance
with Jillian B. Carr, Zachary Knepper, and Matthew Kovach
Estimates the causal effect of legalized sports betting on student academic performance and engagement using quasi-random variation in exposure to live sporting events generated by individual fandom and course schedules of college students.

Presentations

ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC	2027 (upcoming)
SEA Annual Meeting, Houston, TX	2026 (upcoming)
MEA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2026
APPAM Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA	2025
MEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO	2025
Krannert Doctoral Student Association Symposium, Purdue University	2024 (presentation)
Krannert Doctoral Student Association Symposium, Purdue University	2023 (poster)

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, Purdue University

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (56 students, in person)	Fall 2025
Principles of Microeconomics (58 students, in person)	Spring 2025
Principles of Microeconomics (58 students, online)	Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant, Purdue University

Economics of Public Policy (Masters)	Fall 2023, 2024, 2026
International Trade (Undergraduate)	Fall 2022, 2023, 2024
Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2022, Spring 2023

Prior Research Experience

LEAD at Krea University, New Delhi, India
Research Consultant — Feb 2022 – Jun 2022

Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India
Junior Research Fellow (UGC JRF) — Aug 2019 – Jul 2022

Fellowships and Awards

Daniels School Outstanding Teaching Certificate, Purdue University	2025
PGSG Travel Award, Purdue University	2025
EXIM Bank Scholarship, Jawaharlal Nehru University	2019
UGC Junior Research Fellowship, Government of India	2018

Service

Social and Diversity Officer, Krannert Doctoral Student Association, Purdue University — 2023–2025
Initiated KDSA's Research Breakfast (Fall 2024–Spring 2025), which subsequent student leaders continued.
Member, Student Faculty Council, Jawaharlal Nehru University — 2018–2019

Software

R, Stata, Python, MATLAB

Languages

Bengali (Native), English (Fluent), Hindi (Advanced)

References

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